

Northstar Appliances - March 2026 Incident Review

Scenario

Northstar Appliances runs connected refrigeration systems for grocery and healthcare customers. In March 2026, the team investigated compressor shutdowns after an NS-900 firmware rollout. The same customer accounts appear in the image, audio memo, CSV tickets, and this PDF review.

Key Entities

Lakeside Clinic, account C-104, site SEA-17, operated vaccine freezer A.

Harbor Market, account C-118, site PDX-04, operated aisle freezer 3.

Pine Ridge Foods, account C-122, site BOI-02, operated controller 7.

Firmware under review was NS-900 version 4.8.2.

Replacement firmware approved for rollout was NS-900 version 4.8.3.

Priya Shah owned the field runbook update.

Marco Diaz owned the firmware rollout.

Elena Brooks owned customer communication.

Timeline And Root Cause

On 2026-03-04 at 02:14 local time, Lakeside Clinic opened ticket INC-1043.

Vaccine freezer A entered safe mode after three compressor restart attempts.

The case was severity P1 because temperature-sensitive medical inventory was at risk.

Logs showed firmware 4.8.2 retried the condenser fan check too aggressively after a transient sensor fault.

The retry storm increased controller CPU load, delayed telemetry, and triggered safe mode for 47 minutes.

The immediate workaround was cold_chain_safe plus a condenser fan service restart.

CSV metrics for INC-1043 were severity P1, 184000 dollars of inventory at risk, and 47 downtime minutes.

Review Board Decisions

The board decided not to roll back every customer to firmware 4.7.9.

Rollback would disable telemetry compression required by service analytics.

Instead, firmware 4.8.3 rolls out first to healthcare cold-chain accounts, then grocery accounts.

Lakeside Clinic qualifies for an SLA credit and a compliance incident summary.

Harbor Market receives a preventive maintenance notice, but no SLA credit, because cooling stayed in range.

Pine Ridge Foods stays in the pilot group because its delayed defrost was a local night schedule error.